

~~SECRET~~

the attitude you have taken together with your father of strict neutrality, has been an invaluable asset for the production of your companies in Europe."

Opposite this paragraph, on the margin, was a longhand note: "I was the first Frenchman to go to Berlin."

RP His name was Maurice Dollfus and indeed he had compelling business reasons to be the first Frenchman in Berlin after the Armistice. He was Chairman of the Board of the Ford Motor Company's French subsidiary, and under his control during the years of peace, the Ford enterprises of France had never been a financial success. They had declared only ^{ONE} ~~one~~ dividend in their history. There was one way, and only one way, he could strengthen his insecure position and put the company back on its feet. And Professor Earl Krauch, Chairman of the Supervisory Board of the Ford Works at Cologne, was the man to help him do it. After talking to Krauch, he went back to Paris assured that "French Ford" would not be confiscated -- he carried also requisitions from the Wehrmacht -- and between these two facts there may have been some connection.

(near end of 1940),
RP Within a month, Mr. Dollfus received a visit from two men whose credentials, on their face, meant that his trip to Berlin had been in vain -- for the men introduced themselves as the "Commissars" of the Ford plants. But M. Dollfus did not worry. The "Commissars" were a Dr. Albert, Chairman of the Managing Board of the Ford Works at Cologne, and ^{which Professor Krauch had saved for private enterprise} ~~another~~ ^{member of that Board.} ~~also on the Board.~~ They bore the news that he was officially reinstated as "Managing Director